7. The Prime Minister is the sole channel of communication between the President and the Ministers and between the Parliament and his Ministers. He/ she is the chief spokesperson of the government in foreign affairs.

Prime Minister's Office

Meaning

Being the head of the government and the real executive authority, the Prime Minister plays a very vital role in the politico- administrative realm of our country. In order to fulfill his responsibilities, the Prime Minister is assisted by the Prime Minister`s Office (PMO). The Prime Minister`s Office is an agency meant for providing secretarial assistance and advice to the Prime Minister. It is an extra constitutional body which offers important role in the top level decision making process of the Government of India. The Prime Minister`s Office has the status of a department of the Government of India. The Prime Minister`s Office came into existence in 1947. Till 1977, it was called Prime Minister`s Secretariat (PMS). The Prime Minister`s Office is headed politically by the Prime Minister and administratively by the Principal Secretary.

The Prime Minister's Office performs Several Functions

Functions

1. Assists the prime minister in his overall responsibilities as head of the government, in maintaining communication with the central ministries/departments and the state governments.
2. Helps the prime minister in his responsibilities as chairman of the Niti Aayog and the National Development Council.
3. Looks after the public relations of the prime minister like contact with the press and the general public.
4. Deals with all references, which under the Rules of Business have to come to the Prime Minister.
5. Provides assistance to the Prime Minister in the examination of cases submitted to him for orders under prescribed rules.
6. Maintains harmonious relationship with the President, Governors and foreign representatives in the country.
7. Acts as the `think- tank` of the Prime Minister. It deals with all such subjects that are not allotted to any department/ministry.
8. It is not concerned with the responsibility of the Prime Minister as the chairman of the union Cabinet. The Cabinet cases are directly dealt by the Cabinet secretariat, which also functions under the direction of the prime minister.

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